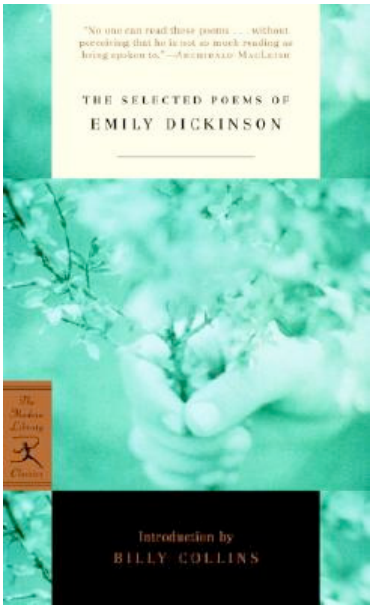
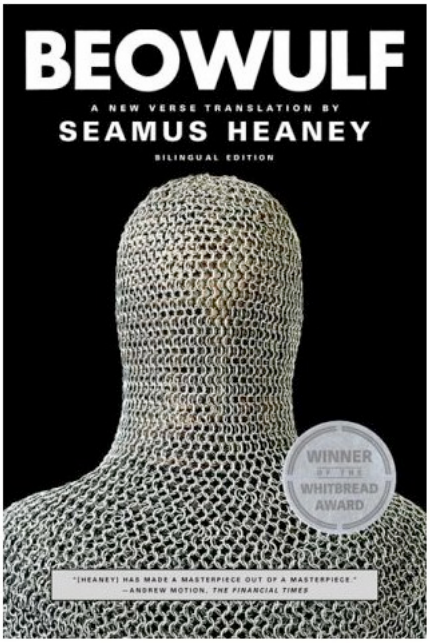
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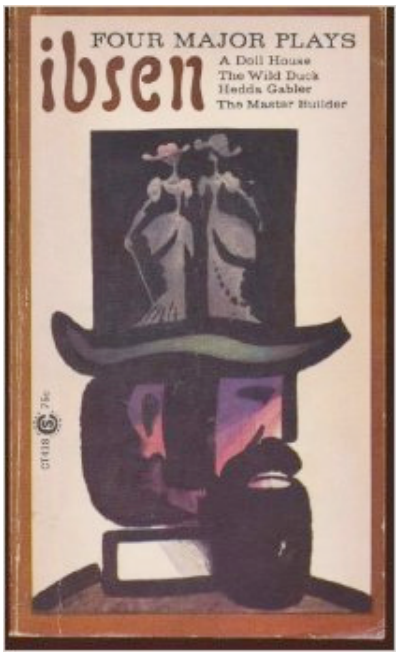
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

District 1 • 2015







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District 1 • 2015

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. Vernacular speech not accepted as suitable for highly formal usage, although much used in everyday conversation, is called (a)

   A) barbarism.
   B) idiom.
   C) jeremiad.
   D) patter.
   E) slang.

2. The late-twentieth to early twenty-first century Irish author of the poetry collections *Door into the Dark, North, The Haw Lantern, District and Circle,* and (his final collection) *Human Chain* is

   A) Samuel Beckett.
   B) J. P. Donleavy.
   C) Seamus Heaney.
   D) George Bernard Shaw.
   E) William Butler Yeats.

3. The form of extended metaphor in which objects, persons, places, and actions in a narrative are equated with meanings outside the narrative itself is a(n)

   A) allegory.
   B) allusion.
   C) almanac.
   D) paradox.
   E) parody.

4. The twentieth-century American author whose novel *The Shipping News* and novella "Brokeback Mountain" have been made into successful movies is

   A) Shirley Ann Grau.
   B) Harper Lee.
   C) Toni Morrison.
   D) Annie Proulx.
   E) Anne Tyler.

5. The term applied to the group of twentieth-century writers in the American South who published *The Fugitive* and who founded the New Criticism is (the)

   A) Agrarians.
   B) Hartford Wits.
   C) Lollards.
   D) Lost Generation.
   E) Muckrakers.

6. The three-line stanza, purportedly devised by Dante, with the rhyme scheme *aba bcb cdc ded* and so forth is called a

   A) tercet.
   B) *terza rima*.
   C) triolet.
   D) triple meter.
   E) trivium.

7. **Not** representative of the genre known as the courtesy book, which flourished in Renaissance times (though there are more recent examples) and dealing with the training of the "courtly" person, is

   A) Castiglione's *The Courtier*.
   B) Stephen Crane's *The Red Badge of Courage*.
   C) Ben Franklin's *Autobiography*.
   D) Henry Peacham's *The Compleat Gentleman*.
   E) Edmund Spenser's *The Faerie Queen*.

8. A term originally applied to painting and now used in the criticism of various literary forms involving the contrast of light and darkness is

   A) chanson.
   B) charade.
   C) chiaroscuro.
   D) chrestomathy.
   E) chronotope.

9. The instructiveness in a literary work, one purpose of which is to give guidance in moral, ethical, or religious matters, is known as

   A) aestheticism.
   B) catechism.
   C) determinism.
   D) didacticism.
   E) humanism.

10. The author of *The Pearl*, *The Red Pony*, *The Winter of Our Discontent* and recipient of the 1940 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *Grapes of Wrath* is

    A) John Cheever.
    B) William Faulkner.
    C) John Hersey.
    D) Larry McMurtry.
    E) John Steinbeck.

11. A work or manner that blends a censorious attitude with humor and wit for improving human institutions or humanity in general is categorized as (an)

A) burlesque.
B) exordium.
C) irony.
D) meliorism.
E) satire.

12. An extended and vigorous verbal exchange, often found in Old English poetry, as well as Greek, Arabic, Celtic, Italian, and Provençal poetry is (the)

A) bombast.
B) flyting.
C) gasconade.
D) rodomontade.
E) stichomythia.

13. The ascription of human characteristics to nonhuman objects or the interpretation of nonhuman things or events in terms of human characteristics is

A) anthropomorphism.
B) hendiadys.
C) kenosis.
D) prosopopoeia.
E) reification.

14. The group of American writers, including Ida Tarbell, Lincoln Steffens, and Upton Sinclair, who between 1902 and 1911 worked to expose the dishonest methods and unscrupulous motives in big business and in city, state, and national government is

A) the Agrarians.
B) the Fugitives.
C) the Hartford Wits.
D) the Lost Generation.
E) the Muckrakers.

15. The three-time recipient of the Pulitzer Prize for Drama whose absurdist plays *The Zoo Story* and *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?* as well as his prize-winning *A Delicate Balance*, *Seascape*, and *Three Tall Women*, have ensured him a place in the American literary canon, is

A) George Aiken.
B) Edward Albee.
C) Arthur Miller.
D) Thornton Wilder.
E) August Wilson.

16. The term literally meaning 'mask' that is widely used to refer to a "second self" created by an author and through whom a narrative is told is

A) allonym.
B) eponym.
C) persona.
D) pseudonym.
E) putative author.

17. The controversial poet whose *Self-Portrait in a Convex Mirror* earned him the 1976 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry is

A) John Ashbery.
B) Richard Eberhart.
C) James Merrill.
D) Mark Strand.
E) Richard Wilbur.

18. **Not** one of the twentieth-century British writer and essayist George Orwell's (Eric Blair's) several novels is

A) *Animal Farm*.
B) *Burmese Days*.
C) *Keep the Aspidistra Flying*.
D) *Nineteen Eighty-Four*.
E) *The Scarlet Letter*.

19. A name frequently applied to the last half of the eighteenth century in England, resulting from historians' seeing the interval between 1750 and 1798 as a seed field for emerging Romantic qualities in literature, is the

A) Age of Johnson.
B) Age of Sensibility.
C) Early Restoration Period.
D) Early Victorian Period.
E) Late Victorian Period.

20. A narrator, like those in George Eliot's *Adam Bede*, Leo Tolstoy's *War and Peace*, and Henry Fielding's *Tom Jones*, whose explanatory, interpretative, and qualifying contributions interrupt the flow of the storytelling is a(n)

A) intrusive narrator.
B) naïve narrator.
C) omniscient narrator.
D) putative author.
E) unreliable narrator.

21. In its figurative sense, the special usage of words, often without the conscious knowledge of the author or reader, in which there is a change in the word's or words' basic meanings is

A) denotation.
B) diction.
C) digression.
D) imagery.
E) plain style.

22. A sustained and formal poem setting forth meditations on death or another solemn theme is a(n)

A) aubade
B) chantey.
C) elegy.
D) encomium.
E) eulogy.

23. A term applied in general to things English and in particular to the English royal court during the second quarter of the seventeenth century, a term that can encompass both Cavalier and Puritan literary expression is

A) Augustine.
B) Caroline.
C) Edwardian.
D) Jacobean.
E) Victorian.

24. The American author whose award-winning novels *No Country for Old Men*, *All the Pretty Horses*, and *The Road* have been adapted for the silver screen is

A) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
B) Joseph Heller.
C) Ernest Hemingway.
D) Cormac McCarthy.
E) John Steinbeck.

25. The term applied to women of pronounced intellectual interest that gained currency after 1750 as a result of its application to a London group of women of literary and intellectual tastes who held meetings to which literary men were invited is the

A) Bloomsbury Group.
B) Bluestockings.
C) Della Cruscans.
D) Geneva School.
E) Hermeneutic Circle.

26. The term that means literally a manifestation or showing forth that designates an event in which the essential nature of something—a person, a situation, an object—is suddenly perceived is

A) apostrophe.
B) epiphany.
C) locus classicus.
D) nekuia.
E) zeugma.

27. **Not** a form of poetry considered to be a pattern poem is the

A) altar poem.
B) *carmen figuratum*.
C) figure poem.
D) rebus.
E) shaped verse.

28. The use of the morbid and the absurd for darkly comic purposes by such modern writers as Günter Grass, Joseph Heller, Thomas Pynchon, Kurt Vonnegut, Jr., Harold Pinter, and Edward Albee is known as

A) black humor.
B) blood and thunder.
C) fantasy.
D) surrealism.
E) travesty.

29. A candidate for the Peruvian presidency in 1990, leading Latin American man of letters, and recipient of the 2010 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Vicente Aleixandre.
B) José Echegaray.
C) Mario Vargas Llosa.
D) Gabriel García Márquez.
E) Pablo Neruda.

30. The first English translation of Boethius' *Consolation of Philosophy*, the first history of the English people, Bede's *Ecclesiastical History*, and the flourishing of the School of Cædmon represent the

A) Anglo-Norman Period.
B) Early Tudor Age.
C) Middle English Period.
D) Neoclassic Period.
E) Old English Period.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Henrik Ibsen's *A Doll House*.
Items 37-42 are associated with Seamus Heaney's translation of *Beowulf*.
Items 43-50 are associated with Emily Dickinson's poetry (selected).

31. In Henrik Ibsen's drama *A Doll House*, Nora is characterized as a "free spender" and a "spendthrift," respectively, by both

A) Anne-Marie and Kristine.
B) Helene and Anne-Marie.
C) Kristine and Nils.
D) Kristine and Torvald.
E) Nils and Dr. Rank.

32. Central to the crisis at the heart of Nora's story is the observation that "[l]aws don't inquire into motives," which is

A) Kristine's defense of Nora.
B) Krogstad's answer to Nora.
C) Nora's comment to herself.
D) Rank's observation to Nora.
E) Torvald's remonstration to Nora.

33. "[Y]ou shut yourself in every evening till long after midnight, making flowers for the Christmas tree, and all the other decorations to surprise us. [. . .] But the outcome was pretty sorry" because the

A) cat tore everything to shreds.
B) children snuck in and opened the presents.
C) dancing of the tarantella was too wild.
D) popcorn strings were eaten by the mice.
E) visitors were not able to appreciate Nora's skill.

34. The confessional statement "Today for the first time I learned that it's you I'm replacing at the bank" is shared by

A) Kristine with Nils.
B) Kristine with Torvald.
C) Nora with Nils.
D) Torvald with Nils.
E) Torvald with Rank.

35. Torvald Helmer's question "[I]s my stubborn little creature calling for a lifeguard?" is in response to Nora's

A) admitting that she ate too many macaroons.
B) asking for forgiveness regarding the forgery.
C) asking for help in planning her costume.
D) complaining about having to raise her children.
E) cowering before a flood of criticism.

36. The troubling confession, "I wouldn't be a man if this feminine helplessness didn't make you twice as attractive to me," is declared by

A) Nils to Anne-Marie.
B) Nils to Helene.
C) Nils to Kristine.
D) Torvald to Kristine.
E) Torvald to Nora.

---

37. In Heaney's *Beowulf* the trophy that the hell-dam, the monstrous hell-bride, the tarn-hag, snatches from the mead-hall is (the)

A) chain mail.
B) Geatish prize for best mead.
C) Grendel's bloodied hand.
D) Grendel's head.
E) Naegling.

38. Beowulf's recounting of some of his exploits, in which he notes that "all knew of my awesome strength" is expected of a warrior-leader and constitutes an example of

A) boasting.
B) caesura.
C) flyting.
D) remonstration.
E) storytelling.

39. Beowulf "order[s] Hrunting / to be brought to Unferth / [. . .] and thanked him for lending it"; Hrunting is a

A) Danish mead cup.
B) GPS device.
C) horse.
D) shield.
E) sword.

40. Hrothgar, speaking about corruption associated with power, addresses all who "have wintered into wisdom," which is a fine example of (a)

A) flyting.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) metaphor.
E) paradox.

41. The Danes, in their desperation to rid themselves of Grendel's destruction turned to their heathen gods, hoping, according to the scop, to be rescued by the

A) God-cursed brute.
B) Head of the Heavens.
C) killer of souls
D) sky-winger.
E) terror of hall-troops.

42. The admonition, "[R]ecollect as well / all of the boons that have been bestowed on you" is delivered by

A) Beowulf to the warriors in Heorot.
B) Hrothgar to the recently arrived Geats.
C) Hygelac to Ecgtheow.
D) Unferth to anyone accepting his challenge.
E) Wealhtheow to the court of Heorot.

Items 43-47 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[The soul selects her own society]

The soul selects her own society,
Then shuts the door;
On her divine majority
Obtrude no more.

Unmoved, she notes the chariot's pausing
At her low gate;
Unmoved, an emperor is kneeling
Upon her mat.

I've known her from an ample nation
Choose one;
Then close the valves of her attention
Like stone.

43. The overriding melopoeic device in the first two lines of the first stanza of Dickinson's poem is

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) onomatopoeia.

44. In the second stanza the imagery, controlled by *chariot* and *emperor* suggests that the speaker

A) dreams of having a horse and chariot.
B) fancies herself living in Roman times.
C) is a princess waiting for a prince.
D) is unfazed by wealth and position.
E) knows that the emperor wants to be part of her life.

45. Dickinson's poem focuses on the soul's

A) cautious approach to dating royalty.
B) frustration stemming from not being able to move.
C) inability to know everyone well.
D) reflection on the stone-like quality of society.
E) single-mindedness in finding a companion.

46. The last line of the poem suggests

A) bullheadedness.
B) defiance.
C) finality.
D) lethargy.
E) weightiness.

47. The second and fourth lines of each of the first two stanzas is a(n)

A) amphiboly.
B) dimeter.
C) dipody.
D) distitch.
E) douzain.

Items 48-50 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[There is no frigate like a book]

There is no frigate like a book
To take us lands away,
Nor any coursers like a page
Of prancing poetry.

This traverse may the poorest take
Without oppress of toll;
How frugal is the chariot
That bears a human soul!

48. The imagery of the poem's first stanza depends on

A) anaphora.
B) inversion.
C) metaphors.
D) paradoxes.
E) similes.

49. Line 5's "traverse [. . .] the poorest [Without oppress of toll] take" is a

A) comical euphemism.
B) mystical scansion.
C) metaphorical journey
D) snarky metalepsis.
E) transferred epithet.

50. The thematic concern of "[There is no frigate like a book]" is (the)

A) books about travel making the best reading.
B) frugality being a metaphor for spirituality.
C) poetry about horses being uplifting.
D) promise of exploration afforded by reading.
E) travel broadens a reader's horizons.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-56 refer to the Anglo-Saxon Poem

Vainglory

Listen! an ancient prophet declared to me in distant days,
a well-informed messenger, many a unique miracle.
This man, masterful in books, unlocked the word-hoard
with a wise man's learning, the foreseeing words of the seer,
so that afterwards I might truly understand
God's own son, that welcome guest in the dwellings,
by (that man's) incantation, (recognize) in my understanding
the feebler one as well, flawed by his faults.
Everyone can easily understand this,
who does not, in this loaned life, let
the lust of the mind murder his memories,
(does not) in his count of days let drunkenness rule,
when so many meeting-givers,
proud war-smiths in the wine-soaked towns
sit in a senate, speak true tales,
trade words: wise ones will discover
what a spear-place lives inside with the people
in that hall when wine whets
a man's mind-thoughts. A murmuring rises,
shouting in the assembly, various men
their harangues. Thus are heart-minds
divided by differences: troop-men are
not alike. In his arrogance a certain one
presses for power, puffs up within
with an uncalmed mind; there are too many of these
So it is that everyone is filled with fury,
with the Enemy's flying arrows, with evil plots
each one barks and bellows, boasts about himself
much more greatly than the good man (does),
imagines that his ways seem to well-near / not
at all despicable. Afterwards comes a second delusion
when he sees the aftermath of his evil.
He sneaks and cheats and thinks up a throng
of underhand (lies), lets loose a thought-spear,
shoots them in showers. He knows then no shame
for feuds fanned up, he flouts his betters,
the noble man for spite, lets a nasty dart
shatter the shield-wall, though the Measurer commanded
that he should *protect* that battle-position.
(He) sits, dinner-proud, deviously
words loose, warped with wine,
(lets) hatreds, violently swollen, hasten out,
inflamed with envy, full of vanity,
nasty, narrow tricks. Now you will recognize,
if you ever meet such a man
living in the towns—realize for your own sake,
with few deliberations, that he is the devil's child
wrapped in flesh, has a filthy life,
a spirit hastening to hell, sickening to God,
the Splendor-king. So sang the seer,
that quick-worded man, and spoke this speech:
"Whoever props himself up in pride
in these sadistic times, exalts himself,
high-handed–he must be humiliated.
After he is crushed down in his corpse-journey,
(he must) live on, transfixed with tortures, surrounded by serpents.
So it was once long ago in God's kingdom
that pride arose among the angels,
a well-known misfortune. They mounted an insurrection,
a pitiless battle-run, polluted heaven,
renounced their ruler, when they intended too treacherously
to rob the rich Glory-King
of his prince-throne, as was not proper,
and then to subjugate glory's joy-land
to their own will. But He withstood them with war,
the Father of first-creation; that fight was too grim for them.
Then so unlike these others is
the one who here on earth lives humbly,
and always keeps peace with kin
among the people and loves his enemies
though they have often made annoyances for him
willfully in this world. He will ascend from here
to the joy of saints, splendor's ecstasy,
into the angels' home. For the others it will not be so,
for those who in arrogant, ugly deeds
live in lusts—their rewards will not be alike
from the Glory-King." Remind yourself of this,
if you meet a humble man,
a servant among the people whose soul,
united, is similar to God's own Son,
wonderful in the world—if the wise one did not deceive me!
Therefore we must always remember in our minds,
meditating at all times on the might of salvation,
the very best Ruler of victories.
Amen.

Trans. Bob Hasenfratz

51. The description of a less-than-honorable mode of expression as a "thought-spear" (34) constitutes a(n)

A) caesura.
B) euphemism.
C) kenning.
D) metonymy.
E) syllepsis.

52. "So it was once long ago in God's kingdom / that pride arose among the angels, / a well-known misfortune" (lines 57-59) is a

A) biblical allusion.
B) classical allusion.
C) historical allusion.
D) literary allusion.
E) topical allusion.

53. "Vainglory" is a fine example of the Celtic and Germanic verse form associated with both the Old English Period and the Middle English Period through the fifteenth century known as

A) alliterative verse.
B) the bob and wheel.
C) cynghanedd.
D) metaphysical poetry.
E) rhopalic verse.

54. The poem contrasts two ways of conducting oneself:one way is with boastful pride; the other is in

A) arrogance.
B) drunkenness.
C) humility.
D) meditation.
E) vaingloriousness.

55. The poem's speaker notes that "when wine whets ['stimulates'] / a man's mind-thoughts. A murmuring rises, / shouting in the assembly, various men their harangues" (18-21); the *murmuring* is an example of

A) cacophony.
B) *hapax legomenon*.
C) mythopoeia.
D) nonce word.
E) onomatopoeia.

56. The phrasing "his ways seem to well-near / not at all despicable" (lines 30-31) centers on

A) ambiguity.
B) chiasmus.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) synecdoche.

Items 57-62 refer to John Davies's poem

[As when the bright cerulean firmament]

As when the bright cerulean firmament*
  Hath not his glory with black clouds defaced
So were my thoughts void of all discontent
  And with no mist of passions overcast
They all were pure and clear, till at the last
  An idle careless thought for the wand'ring went
and of that poisonous beauty took a taste
  Which does the hearts of lovers so torment.
Then as it chanceth in a flock of sheep
  When some contagious ill breeds first in one
Daily it spreads and secretly doth creep
  Till all the silly troop be overgone;
    So by close neighbourhood within my breast
    One scurvy* thought infecteth all the rest.

* **deep blue sky**
* **arousing disgust**

57. John Davies's "[As when the bright cerulean firmament]" both begins with and turns on a

A) euphemism.
B) hyperbole.
C) paradox.
D) simile.
E) syllepsis.

58. The repetition of the vocalic quality that threads through "When some contagious ill breeds first in one / Daily it spreads and secretly doth creep / Till all the silly troop be over-gone" (10-12) is called

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance
D) resonance.
E) sigmatism.

59. While the sonnet's rhyme scheme is a fairly rare variant, Davies's sonnet most closely conforms to the

A) Anglo-Italian sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

60. The phrase "poisonous beauty" (line 7) can be understood as being subtly

A) didactic.
B) hyperbolic.
C) metonymic.
D) oxymoronic.
E) syllogistic.

61. The narrative turn upon which the sonnet relies as it moves from one comparison to another occurs at the beginning of line

A) 3.
B) 9.
C) 11.
D) 12.
E) 13.

62. The sonnet's lyric nature, especially in terms of its focusing on a personally experienced emotional response, contributes to the poem's

A) cautionary tone.
B) dramatic braggadocio.
C) monotonous imagery.
D) stanzaic structure.
E) unenlightening irony.

Items 63-65 refer to Wilfred Owen's poem

Arms and the Boy

Let the boy try along this bayonet-blade
How cold steel is, and keen with hunger of blood;
Blue with all malice, like a madman's flash;
And thinly drawn with famishing for flesh. 4

Lend him to stroke these blind, blunt bullet-heads
Which long to nuzzle in the hearts of lads.
Or give him cartridges of fine zinc teeth,
Sharp with the sharpness of grief and death. 8

For his teeth seem for laughing round an apple.
There lurk no claws behind his fingers supple;
And God will grow no talons at his heels,
Nor antlers through the thickness of his curls. 12

63. In Wilfred Owen's poem "Arms and the Boy" the dissonance of war determinedly echoes in the melopoeic use of

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) feminine rhyme.
D) identical rhyme.
E) internal rhyme.

64. Lines 5-6, which suggest that the "blind, blunt bullet-heads / Which long to nuzzle in the hearts of lads," depend for its full effect on

A) affective fallacy.
B) hyperbole.
C) onomatopoeia.
D) pathetic fallacy.
E) personification.

65. The imagery in which are couched the boy's teeth and his lack of claws constitutes, effectively, a(n)

A) absurdist contrast.
B) anatomical contrast.
C) moral contrast.
D) semiotic contrast.
E) surrealistic contrast.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Emily Dickinson's "[The mushroom is the elf of plants]," and address the poet's use of comparison, specifically simile, metaphor, and allusion.

[The mushroom is the elf of plants]

The mushroom is the elf of plants,
At evening, it is not;
At morning, in a truffled* hut
It stops upon a spot

As if it tarried* always;
And yet its whole career
Is shorter than a snake's delay,
And fleeter than a tare.*

'T is vegetation's juggler,
The germ of alibi;
Doth like a bubble antedate,*
And like a bubble hie.*

I feel as if the grass were pleased
To have it intermit;*
This surreptitious* scion#
Of summer's circumspect.

Had nature any outcast face,
Could she a son contemn,*
Had nature an Iscariot,*
That mushroom,—it is him.

Emily Dickinson

*** an adjective derived from a synonym for mushroom**

*** delayed progress**

*** an invasive plant**

*** occur before**

*** to go quickly**

*** pause at intervals**

*** stealthy**

next generation of a plant

*** despise**

*** Judas who betrayed Jesus**

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
2. ____
3. ____
4. ____
5. ____
6. ____
7. ____
8. ____
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24. ____
25. ____
26. ____
27. ____
28. ____
29. ____
30. ____

Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
32. ____
33. ____
34. ____
35. ____
36. ____
37. ____
38. ____
39. ____
40. ____
41. ____
42. ____
43. ____
44. ____
45. ____
46. ____
47. ____
48. ____
49. ____
50. ____
51. ____
52. ____
53. ____
54. ____
55. ____
56. ____
57. ____
58. ____
59. ____
60. ____
61. ____
62. ____
63. ____
64. ____
65. ____

Part 3

contestant number

SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism
District 1 • 2015

line arrows up ➔

1.	E	447
2.	C	587
3.	A	12
4.	D	592
5.	A	279
6.	B	475
7.	B	
8.	C	84
9.	D	142
10.	E	602
11.	E	427
12.	B	201
13.	A	30
14.	E	309
15.	B	608
16.	C	361
17.	A	605
18.	E	561
19.	B	9
20.	A	256
21.	D	246
22.	C	167
23.	B	75
24.	D	
25.	B	62
26.	B	178
27.	D	401
28.	A	58
29.	C	601
30.	E	516
31.	D	50
32.	B	67
33.	A	47
34.	A	95
35.	C	69
36.	E	107
37.	C	1303
38.	A	418
39.	E	1807
40.	D	294
41.	C	77
42.	E	1172
43.	A	13
44.	D	
45.	E	
46.	C	
47.	B	144
48.	E	445
49.	C	
50.	D	
51.	C	266
52.	A	
53.	A	14
54.	C	
55.	E	337
56.	D	275
57.	D	445
58.	A	43
59.	B	173
60.	D	345
61.	B	
62.	A	
63.	B	107
64.	E	361
65.	C	

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, to the Signet *House*, to the Norton *Beowulf*, and to Collins's Dickinson collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Emily Dickinson's "[The mushroom is the elf of plants]"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the figures of comparison—similes, metaphors, and allusions—in Emily Dickinson's "[The mushroom is the elf of plants]" include

alliteration,
allusion,
antecedent,
assonance,
connotation,
consonance,
contrast,
denotation,
enjambment,
imagery,
metaphor,
paradox,
personification,
rhyme,
rhythm,
sigmatism,
simile,
speaker,
tenor and vehicle, and
tone.

The young writer should recognize that Dickinson's poem progresses through a series of comparisons, the overwhelming majority of which are metaphors and similes, the allusion ending the poem characterizing the capstone comparison. The writer might focus on the shift that occurs in line 13, at which point the speaker offers a personal assessment of the nature of the relationship that the mushroom has with the rest of the vegetation, including the tare (line 8), which is also considered unwanted.

The contestant might instead focus on the imagery that is embedded in the vehicles of the comparisons: an elf, not an elf, a snake, a tare, a juggler, a germ of an alibi, a bubble (a pair of similes balancing as a paradox), an offshoot of the summer's otherwise carefulness, and the pointed last clause, which declares that the mushroom is Judas.

The thread of comparison that culminates in the speaker's allusion to Judas Iscariot as son despised (lines 17-19)—the mushroom as an outcast from the world of vegetation—gives the writer an opportunity to address the personification of grass being pleased with the mushroom as intermittent interloper.

Any recognition of the poet's inclination to speak in terms of nature (obvious), religion (the allusion), or death (the mushroom's life cycle) should be *specific* to the poem's imagery and diction.